



Technology group being set up for policy advice

A 12-member technology group has been approved by Union Cabinet to advise ministers, departments and public sector undertakings on technology implementation. The group will be headed by Dr K. Vijay Raghvan, principal scientific adviser to prime minister.

The group will draw experts from various fields to provide timely

policy advice on the latest technologies. In future, it might also advise the concerned industries. It will also help in commercialisation of technologies developed in various government laboratories, and in developing some key technologies indigenously.

“Currently, all ministries and departments bring in new tech-

nologies on their own; however, they cannot say whether it is really the latest and the most useful because they do not have the capacity to judge the technologies. The group will advise on policy, procurement and managing the technologies,” said Prakash Javadekar, Union minister for Information & Broadcasting and the Environment.

Solar vehicle market to reach \$4.08 billion by 2030

The global solar vehicle market is estimated to reach \$329.5 million by 2023, as reported by Allied Market Research. Further, the market is expected to garner \$4.08 billion by 2030, growing at a CAGR of 43.3 per cent from 2023 to 2030.

As per Allied, the global solar vehicle market will be driven by a

rise in concerns related to environmental pollution and an increase in demand for energy-efficient solutions. But less operational frequency and high costs related to the integration of technology may act as a barrier to growth.

The passenger vehicle segment is estimated to account for nearly

three-fifths of the total share of the global solar vehicle market in 2023. This is due to emergence of electric and hybrid vehicles using the self-charging concept. The commercial vehicle segment is projected to grow at the highest CAGR of 45.2 per cent from 2023 to 2030 due to demand for emission-free vehicles.

Plan to boost local mobile manufacturing further

As per a newspaper report, the government is working on a ₹ 420 billion plan to boost local manufacturing of mobile phones under the Make in India scheme. It plans to offer a benefit of four to six per cent on incremental sales of goods manufactured locally for a period of five years. The beneficiaries of this scheme will be companies like Apple Foxconn, Flex, and Wistron, besides local players like Micromax, Karbonn, Lava, and Intex.

The scheme to be rolled out by the IT ministry has been prepared in consultation with the ministries

of finance and commerce and NITI Aayog. It aims to make India a hub for the manufacture of electronics and components.

The scheme will be applicable to devices with an invoice value of \$200 or more only, which will exclude many mobile makers like Vivo and Oppo. As per the report, the package is likely to be disbursed in tranches with around ₹ 40.3 billion planned to be disseminated in the first year, ₹ 63.95 billion in the second year, ₹ 87.6 billion in third, ₹ 117.9 billion in the fourth, and ₹ 10.2 billion in the fifth year.

Triple-camera models take the lead in the smartphone market

Triple-camera smartphones have become the most popular type of model on the market, exceeding dual-camera

devices for the first time. Models with three cameras accounted for 31 per cent of global smartphone shipments during

ON THE move

Xerox India appoints Joseph as MD

Xerox has appointed Leo Joseph as managing director for India and South Asia market. He has over 28 years of experience with large enterprises, SMBs, governments, and B2C consumers across the value chain. Before Xerox, Leo was associated with HP, where he held various senior leadership roles in India and APAC. Previously, he had also worked with IBM India.

Pekka replacing Rajeev Suri at Nokia

Rajeev Suri, president and CEO of Nokia, is expected to hand over charge to Pekka Lundmark on August 31, 2020. Suri joined Nokia in 1996 and was their CEO since April 2014. He will, however, continue to work as adviser for Nokia until January 1, 2021. Lundmark is currently president and CEO of Fortum, Finland.